

CONTOSO CORPORATION

Enterprise Business Brief

Intelligent Enterprise Transformation Initiative

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1. Executive Summary

Contoso Corporation operates across five regional markets (North, South, East, West, and Central). Despite strong brand recognition and a loyal customer base of over 2,000 active accounts, the organisation is experiencing significant performance pressure. Revenue is declining in key regions, customer satisfaction scores are below target, and operational teams are unable to respond quickly enough to emerging business issues due to fragmented data and manual reporting processes.

This brief defines the business case, problem statement, target architecture, and key performance indicators for Contoso's Intelligent Enterprise Transformation — a programme to unify data, embed AI-driven insights, and automate operational workflows using Microsoft Fabric, Azure AI Foundry, and Microsoft 365.

2. Current State Assessment

2.1 Business Performance Overview

The following table summarises the latest monthly revenue figures and customer satisfaction scores across Contoso's five regions:

Region	Revenue (Jan 2024)	vs. Dec 2023	Avg Customer Rating	Products Below Reorder
NORTH	£425,000	−15.0 %	3.1 / 5	8
SOUTH	£610,000	+5.2 %	4.2 / 5	2
EAST	£390,000	−7.1 %	3.5 / 5	5
WEST	£470,000	+3.3 %	3.8 / 5	1
CENTRAL	£395,000	+2.6 %	4.0 / 5	1

2.2 Key Business Challenges

Challenge 1: Data siloed across 5 regional systems

Each region maintains its own sales, inventory, and customer databases. There is no consolidated view of performance, making cross-regional analysis impossible without manual effort.

Challenge 2: Manual, spreadsheet-based reporting

Finance and operations teams produce weekly performance reports in Excel. Data is typically 2–3 weeks old by the time it reaches leadership, resulting in decisions based on stale information.

Challenge 3: Customer feedback not analysed at scale

Customer satisfaction data is collected through regional contact centres but is never systematically analysed. Leadership has no visibility into the drivers of dissatisfaction or the regions most at risk of customer churn.

Challenge 4: No AI or automation in business workflows

All alerts, escalations, and management actions are initiated manually. When a business issue arises, the average response time is 24–48 hours, creating significant competitive risk.

Challenge 5: No governance framework for data and AI

There are no data classification policies, row-level security controls, or AI usage guidelines in place. This creates compliance risk as the organisation scales its use of analytics and AI.

3. User Personas

The transformation programme serves three distinct user personas, each with different needs and interaction patterns:

Persona	Role	Primary Tools	Key Goals
Data Engineer	Builds and maintains data pipelines	Fabric Lakehouse, Notebooks, Dataflows	Consolidate and clean data from all regions
Business Analyst	Creates reports and explores data	Power BI, Copilot in Fabric	Generate insights; detect anomalies in real time
Business User	Makes decisions and takes actions	M365 Copilot, Teams, Outlook	Understand and act on AI-driven recommendations

4. Target Architecture

The proposed solution is built on three interconnected pillars, all operating within the Microsoft Cloud ecosystem:

Pillar	Platform	Key Components	Addresses Challenge
Data Foundation (Fabric IQ)	Microsoft Fabric	OneLake, Lakehouse (Bronze/Silver/Gold), Semantic Model, Power BI	1, 2
AI Intelligence (Foundry IQ)	Azure AI Foundry	GPT-4o, Prompt Flow, RAG Pipeline, AI Search, Index	3, 4
Business Workflows (Work IQ)	Microsoft 365	M365 Copilot, Copilot Studio, Power Automate, Teams	4, 5

Medallion Architecture: Raw data is ingested into OneLake as Bronze layer files. Transformation notebooks produce Silver (cleaned) tables and Gold (aggregated, business-ready) tables. A Semantic Model sits on top of the Gold layer and feeds Power BI reports and AI workflows.

5. Data Assets

The following datasets form the foundation of the solution. All files are pre-loaded into OneLake and are available at the paths shown:

Dataset	File Name	OneLake Path	Key Columns
Sales Transactions	sales_transactions.csv	Files/raw/sales/	TransactionID, SaleDate, Region, ProductID, Quantity
Inventory	inventory_data.csv	Files/raw/inventory/	ProductID, ProductName, Category, StockLevel, Location
Customer Feedback	customer_feedback.csv	Files/raw/feedback/	FeedbackID, CustomerID, FeedbackDate, Rating, Comments
Sales Drop Simulation	sales_drop_simulation.csv	Files/raw/sales/	Same as Sales Transactions (8 simulation rows)

6. Success Metrics (KPIs)

KPI	Current Baseline	Target	Measurement Method
Reporting cycle time	2 weeks	< 1 hour	Power BI dashboard refresh time
Time-to-insight	3 days	< 15 minutes	From event to AI recommendation
Customer satisfaction	3.2 / 5	> 4.0 / 5	Sentiment analysis of feedback data
Alert response time	24–48 hours	< 1 hour	Power Automate flow trigger to action
Data freshness	2–3 weeks old	Near real-time	Lakehouse pipeline schedule

7. North Region: Detailed Analysis

The North region requires immediate attention. The following indicators point to a compounding issue that has not yet been fully diagnosed due to the lack of integrated analytics:

- Revenue declined by 15.0% from December 2023 (£500,000) to January 2024 (£425,000).
- Average customer rating is 3.1 / 5 — the lowest of all five regions.
- 8 out of 8 North-warehouse products are currently below their reorder point.
- The most common customer complaint theme is 'delivery delays', which correlates with the low stock levels.
- If the 8 below-reorder products go out of stock entirely, the North region faces a further estimated revenue loss of £120,000–£180,000 per month.
- Customer churn risk is elevated: 35% of North region feedback rated ≤ 2 / 5 in January 2024.

Recommended immediate actions: (1) Initiate emergency restocking for all 8 below-reorder products. (2) Deploy a customer recovery programme targeting customers who gave ratings of ≤ 2 in Q4 2023. (3) Assign a dedicated operations lead for the North region until performance stabilises.

8. Transformation Roadmap

Phase	Exercise	Focus Area	Key Deliverable
1	Exercise 2	Data Foundation	Unified Lakehouse with Bronze/Silver/Gold layers; Power BI dashboard
2	Exercise 3	Intelligent Insights	Copilot-powered analytics; data-driven alerts; AI-ready dataset

Phase	Exercise	Focus Area	Key Deliverable
3	Exercise 4	AI Intelligence	Prompt Flow for sentiment analysis; RAG pipeline for contextual Q&A
4	Exercise 5	Workflow Automation	Copilot Studio agent; Power Automate flows; Teams/Outlook integration
5	Exercise 6	End-to-End Validation	Simulated sales drop scenario; full pipeline validation against KPIs
6	Exercise 7	Governance & Responsible AI	RBAC; Row-Level Security; Content Safety; Audit logging

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